

Bad programs

Not all programs are fun games or useful apps. Some programs are designed to steal your data or damage your computer. They will often seem harmless, and you might not realize that you have been a victim.

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◀ 194–195 The Internet

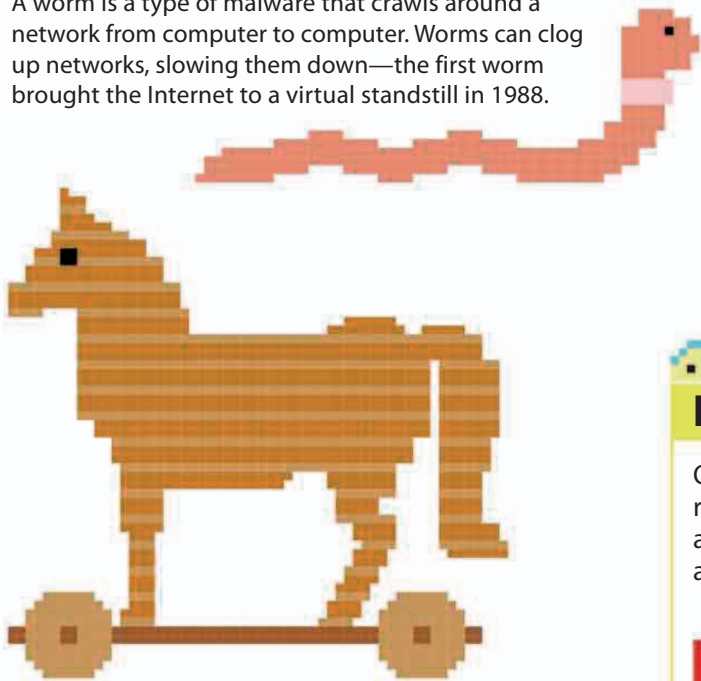
◀ 202–203 Busy programs

Malware

Programs that do things without your knowledge or permission are known as “malware”. Unauthorized access to a computer is a crime, but there are many different types of programs that still try to sneak on to your computer.

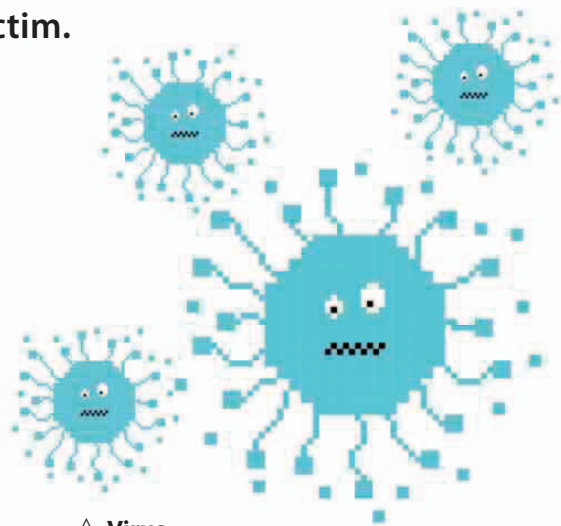
▷ Worm

A worm is a type of malware that crawls around a network from computer to computer. Worms can clog up networks, slowing them down—the first worm brought the Internet to a virtual standstill in 1988.



△ Trojan

Malware that pretends to be a harmless program is known as a “trojan”. The word comes from a ruse used in the Trojan War: the Greeks gave the Trojans a giant wooden horse, with soldiers hidden inside. By breaching the Trojan defenses without detection, they won the war.



△ Virus

Just like a virus in the human body, this malware copies itself over and over again. They are usually spread through emails, USB sticks, or other methods of transferring files between computers.



REAL WORLD

Famous worm

On May 5, 2000, Internet users in the Philippines received emails with the subject “ILOVEYOU”. An attachment appeared to be a love letter, but was actually a piece of malware that corrupted files.



◁ ILOVEYOU

This worm quickly spread to computers around the world. It is estimated to have cost more than \$20 billion to fix the damage it caused.